George Ashinze

Cybersecurity analyst & IT officer · Abuja, Nigeria
CompTIA Security+ · MSc Cyber Security & Penetration Testing

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01 About

Cyber security analyst and IT officer based in Abuja, Nigeria, with an MSc in Cyber Security and Penetration Testing from Middlesex University Dubai. I work across offensive and defensive security (vulnerability assessments, phishing simulations, incident response) and run a Proxmox / OPNsense homelab with segmented VLANs.

Certifications

CompTIA Security+ (2024)

Soft skills

Adaptability · Attention to detail · Collaboration · Communication · Problem-solving

Off the clock

Gaming · Golfing · Swimming · Volleyball

02 Skills

Offensive

Penetration testing · Vulnerability assessments · Security audits · Phishing simulations · Social engineering assessments · Nessus · Evilginx · Gophish · OSINT tools

Defensive

Incident response · Security hardening · Firewall management (pfSense, OPNsense) · IDS/IPS (Snort) · Endpoint protection · Security log analysis · Monitoring systems · Post-incident reporting · Mitigation strategies

Infrastructure

VPN (WireGuard, OpenVPN) · Network segmentation · VLAN setup · Virtualization (Proxmox) · TrueNAS · OpenMediaVault (OMV) · RAID configurations · NAS setup (Raspberry Pi, TrueNAS) · Server configuration · VPS configuration · Azure (honeypot deployments) · Cloud services · Remote access security

Engineering

Python · Git · Software testing · Debugging · Quality assurance · Secure system design · Documentation · Technical and procedural recommendations

03 Projects

Home Lab

Designed and implemented a virtualized lab using Proxmox, OPNsense and VLANs to replicate enterprise-grade network segmentation and security. Deployed and managed automation, monitoring and media services, including Jellyfin, Tailscale and the *Arr stack, with advanced firewall configuration for performance and security.

Proxmox · OPNsense · VLANs · Jellyfin · Tailscale · *Arr stack

VPS VPN Setup

Configured a VPS as a VPN server to forward traffic to a VPN client behind a CGNAT router, enabling access to self-hosted services on the local network.

VPS · VPN · CGNAT

Local NAS Setup

Implemented multiple Raspberry Pi-based NAS for local file storage and management.

Raspberry Pi · NAS

Phishing Simulation Setup

Conducted home-lab phishing emulation using Evilginx (lab only) to emulate credential-theft scenarios and evaluate detection and defense effectiveness.

Evilginx · Phishing · Lab only

Azure Honeypot

Deployed and managed a honeypot in an Azure test environment to emulate exposed services and collect attack telemetry. Analyzed intrusion patterns and attacker techniques to improve detection rules and hardening strategies.

Azure · Honeypot · Detection

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04 Experience

IT Officer, Anti-Corruption and Transparency Unit

`Nigeria Education Loan Fund · Sep 2024 – Present · FCT–Abuja, Nigeria`

- Orchestrated the design of IT infrastructure for the Anti-Corruption & Transparency Unit, aligned with anti-corruption objectives and scalable for future transparency initiatives.
- Played a key role in selecting software tools to improve workflow efficiency, in line with anti-corruption standards and data transparency initiatives.
- Designed secure systems for sensitive data management, implementing encryption, user authentication and cybersecurity protocols to protect against unauthorized access.
- Designed and configured a demo prototype for an anonymous whistleblowing system, laying the foundation for confidential reporting of corruption.
- Ran an organization-wide phishing simulation with the IT department by configuring GoPhish and Postfix mail servers, assessing staff cyber awareness and identifying areas for targeted training.

Freelance IT / Cybersecurity Consultant

`Defense Intelligence Agency · Sep 2024 – Present · FCT–Abuja, Nigeria`

- Provide ongoing IT and cybersecurity consulting, advising on threat mitigation, security architecture improvements and risk assessment frameworks to strengthen the agency's defensive posture.

Cyber Security Analyst

Defense Intelligence Agency · Sep 2023 – Sep 2024 · FCT–Abuja, Nigeria

- Supported cyber operations across agency infrastructure, including vulnerability assessments, phishing simulations, open-source intelligence (OSINT) research and incident response.
- Took part in authorized red team and phishing-awareness exercises using Evilginx and Gophish to measure and improve staff resilience to phishing.
- Carried out OSINT research to support threat assessments, incident triage and planning.
- Performed vulnerability scans and security assessments with in-house tools and custom scripts to find and remediate misconfigurations and critical exposures.
- Helped deploy and manage security infrastructure including pfSense firewalls, Snort IDS and an in-house endpoint protection solution.
- Analyzed system and security logs to detect anomalies, investigate incidents and refine detection and response workflows.
- Configured and maintained secure local storage with TrueNAS and OpenMediaVault (OMV), using RAID for redundancy and resilience.
- Deployed WireGuard VPN on virtual private servers to give clients behind CGNAT encrypted remote access to internal services.
- Supported cyber awareness initiatives with staff training on phishing, social engineering and safe digital practices.
- Produced detailed post-incident reports, documented findings and recommended technical and procedural mitigations.

Software Development Intern

Prunedge Development Technologies · Jan 2023 – Nov 2023 · FCT–Abuja, Nigeria

- Assisted in developing and testing software applications, including debugging and troubleshooting.
- Worked with software engineering teams to design and ship features and enhancements based on user feedback, improving usability.
- Took part in code reviews and quality assurance processes to keep code aligned with project specifications.

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05 Education

MSc Cyber Security and Penetration Testing

Middlesex University · Sep 2021 – Nov 2022 · Dubai, U.A.E

BSc Information Technology

Middlesex University · Jan 2021 – Sep 2021 · Dubai, U.A.E

Advanced Diploma in Software Engineering

APTECH Computer Education Centre · Sep 2018 – Dec 2020 · FCT–Abuja, Nigeria